



YOU SAID IT



Love to read OSFY

I am a regular reader of *OSFY*. It's a wonderful magazine for those interested in open source and has helped me a lot to pick up new tips and learn techniques in this domain. I am really thankful to the team behind the magazine for helping me enhance my knowledge in the field I am in love with. The August issue is really good in terms of content and design. In fact, I was able to clear all my doubts associated with the topics included in this issue. Let me also tell you that what I loved reading the most in this edition was 'CoffeeScript'. Looking forward to more such informative content.

—**Shashank Baje**, shashankbaje@yahoo.in

ED: First of all, a big thank you for your words of appreciation. Through the years, we have constantly worked at improving the content, layout and design of the magazine in order to make your reading experience more enjoyable. We will certainly pass on your compliments to CoffeeScript's author, Magimai Prakash. And as *OSFY* readers have always done, we urge you to continue sharing your opinion with us, as this motivates us and helps us to do even better.



Include more content on embedded Linux

I am a regular reader of *OSFY*. In the DVD that always accompanies every issue, and in the magazine itself, I feel that there isn't much information related to embedded Linux, such as Linux on ARM architecture, memory management in ARM-Linux, complex topics like video for Linux drivers, etc. Most of the content seems to be for x86 architecture and applies to desktops. I would sincerely request you to add more articles on embedded Linux, for architectures such as ARM, etc, as there are many embedded Linux/Android developers in India who would benefit from this.

—**YK**, yogidk@gmail.com

ED: Thanks a lot for reaching out to us with your suggestion. We have taken note of it and will certainly give it our consideration in future editions. In fact, such constructive feedback helps us to align the content of the magazine with our readers' needs. We value your inputs as these help us to constantly improve our content and deliver to our readers' satisfaction; so keep writing to us.



Are the Andaman & Nicobar Islands contributing towards open source?

Having lived on the Andaman & Nicobar Islands for 30 years, and having worked on the Linux platform for the last seven, I am sure that in spite of having a great talent pool of qualified

professionals from the IT sector, the islands are not contributing enough to the open source community.

Why? Well, this is a debatable issue.

In the last few years, our islands have witnessed only average growth in the IT/TES sector. This has come from many small and medium IT-enabled service providers who have developed PHP, MySQL-based applications and websites for private firms (a majority of them being tourism service providers), as open source software is lightweight and can easily run on the slowest possible broadband speeds (Internet connectivity and speed has always been a major issue on our islands). A few government departments have also developed and implemented their websites and software based entirely on open source. However, there is a deficit of highly skilled contributors and I doubt whether the so-called software engineers contribute for free to the open source community.

Regarding infrastructure, I haven't seen any firm or government department using full-fledged Linux-based systems, clusters and cloud technologies and, surprisingly, you may not find even RAID/LVM on servers implemented here. In offices, you will still find PCs running only Windows XP or Windows 8 protected by anti-virus, and various other proprietary software made only for Windows.

Besides, here, all computer training centres teach only Windows-based applications, like MS-Office, VB, .NET, etc. While cities like Chennai, Bengaluru, Gurgaon, Mumbai and other parts of India have Linux and open source professionals, our islands are lagging behind and are still stuck in the Microsoft era.

It's true that our islands do not have IT companies like in other states of India, and those that do exist are a few small firms that work only towards website development; they download OSS from various sites, modify and test it, and then fade out.

A lot of work has to be done on the ground to create strong awareness about Linux and its advantages. This will require a few benevolent Linux and open source enthusiasts to come forward and perform this task in some meaningful way. And, of course, infrastructure is required to support and contribute towards OSS.

Maybe *OSFY* could encourage enthusiasts of open source technologies from these islands by inviting them to develop and contribute new applications and highlight their contributions in your magazine. You never know, there may be hidden talent in these remote islands too.

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